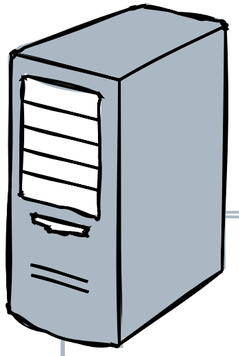
n8n

WHAT IS DOCKER?



WINDOWS (or MAC, Linux, Chrome OS)

DOCKER (desktop with a GUI, or command line)

Runs containers
Controls consumption and access to host resources
Stores state data in volumes

CONTAINERS

http://localhost:5678

N8N CONTAINER

N8N DATA

REDIS CONTAINER

Pull

Pull

DOCKER HUB

Repo of images are published by their authors

N8N IMAGE
Alpine OS, Node, n8n +Dependencies

POSTGRESQL IMAGE

REDIS IMAGE

n8n

WHY USE DOCKER?

ENVIRONMENT CONISTENCY

No worries about Node.js version, OS version, system libraries.
"Works on my machine" is not an issue, it just works because they...
n8n test it first before the docker image is available.

HOST MACHINE STAYS CLEAN

No installing Node, npm and various packages on your local computer

SECURITY & STABILITY

Docker isolates resources, can cap them.
The container is isolated from your host computer, in the scenario where someone breaches your local n8n that you expose to the internet, your host PC is unaffected.

COMPOSE

Using a compose file you can add other containers and features for n8n to use.
PostgreSQL (upgrade from the default SQL Lite),
Redis (for queued mode)
Caddy (for SSL and reverse proxy)
Local AI models in containers.

BACKUPS, RESTORES AND PORTABILITY

Export the n8n volume in a few clicks to backup all the n8n config and data.
Import the volume in a few clicks to restore a previous backup.
Copy the n8n volume and the compose file to another machine and you can move your installation anywhere (VPS? different PC?)

EASY UPDATES

docker compose up .... aaaaand you're done